

SPYNE

Global Travel & Reimbursement Policy

Applicable to All Employees · India & United States

Document Details

Version	Effective Date	Document Owner	Classification
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⚠ IMPORTANT NOTICE

This policy supersedes all prior travel policies, verbal understandings, or informal practices. All employees — India and United States — are required to read, understand, and comply in full.

Employees are expected to familiarise themselves with this Policy. Non-compliance may result in disciplinary action in accordance with applicable company policies This document constitutes an internal workplace policy and guideline. It does not form part of any employment contract and may be amended by the Company from time to time.

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QUICK-REFERENCE SUMMARY

Key entitlements at a glance — read this first

The table below provides a side-by-side summary of key travel entitlements by geography. For full details, refer to the relevant section of this policy.

APPROVAL LEAD TIMES		
	India	United States
Travel Category	Before travel — HOD approval	Before travel — HOD approval
Domestic outstation	15 business days prior intimation	15 business days prior intimation
International travel	30 business days prior intimation	30 business days prior intimation

FLIGHT CLASS		
	India	United States
All travel	Economy class only	Economy class only
Upgrade	At own cost	At own cost

Train/ Cab		
	India	United States
Train	2nd AC	Coach Classes
Cab	Economy transport only — Ola/ Uber, standard taxi.	Economy transport only — Uber X/ Go, Lyft, standard taxi
Upgrade	At own cost	At own cost

ACCOMMODATION CAPS (per night)		
	India	United States
Tier A / Major metros	Up to INR 6,000 + taxes	Up to USD 130 (New York, Los Angeles, San Francisco, Las Vegas, Boston, Washington, Houston, Dallas, Miami, Seattle, Atlanta)
Tier B / Standard	Up to INR 4,000 + taxes	Up to USD 120 (other US cities)

MEALS / PER DIEM				
	 India		 United States	
	Tier A	Tier B	Tier A	Tier B
Domestic (Intercity)	Up to INR 800/day (bills required)	Up to INR 800/day (bills required)	USD 70/day (bills needed)	USD 60/day (bills needed)
International	INR 1200/day (bills needed)	INR 1200/day (bills needed)	USD 70/day (no bills needed)	USD 60/day (no bills needed)

LOCAL TRANSPORT (at destination)		
	 India	 United States
Within city	Actuals — economy cab/metro/auto	Actuals — economy cab/ metro
Daily cap (overseas)	INR 1000/day (bills required)	USD 50/day (bills required)
Personal vehicle	INR 4.5/km (2W) · INR 8/km (4W)	IRS standard mileage rate
Premium/luxury rides	NOT reimbursable	NOT reimbursable

CLAIM SUBMISSION TIMELINES		
	 India	 United States
Within city / local	7 business days from expense date	7 business days from expense date
Domestic outstation	10 business days from return date	10 business days from return date
International travel	15 business days from return date	15 business days from return date
Tour advance settlement	30 calendar days from return	30 calendar days from return

01

PURPOSE & SCOPE

Why this policy exists and what it governs

This Global Travel & Reimbursement Policy ('Policy') establishes a uniform, transparent, and equitable framework governing all business-related travel undertaken by Spyne employees across Spyne (India) and Spyne Inc. (United States). The Policy is designed to ensure fiscal responsibility, employee safety, operational clarity, and legal compliance in all geographies where Spyne operates.

Specifically, this Policy aims to:

- Define reimbursable and non-reimbursable travel expenses for both domestic and international travel
- Establish clear entitlements differentiated by geography and employee level
- Provide a standardised approval and claims process to prevent misuse of company funds
- Protect both the company and the employee through transparent documented procedures
- Ensure compliance with applicable labour laws, tax regulations, and corporate governance standards in India and the United States

 LEGAL NOTICE

LEGAL NOTICE — LIMITATION OF LIABILITY: To the extent permitted under applicable law, Spyne shall not be liable for any indirect, incidental, or consequential losses arising during business travel. Nothing in this Policy limits liability where such limitation is not permitted under applicable law. Travel outside the scope of approved business purposes is entirely at the employee's personal risk and expense. Employees may not use any gap, ambiguity, or silence in this Policy as a basis to make financial, legal, or reputational claims against the company.

02

APPLICABILITY

Who is covered and what travel qualifies

This Policy applies to:

- All full-time and part-time employees on the payroll of Spyne (India) and Spyne AI Inc. (United States)
- Contractors, interns, and consultants are NOT covered unless explicitly stated in their engagement letter
- Travel must be pre-approved business travel — personal travel or personal extensions of business trips are excluded
- Claims must be filed within the timelines specified in this Policy; late claims may be declined at the company's discretion

NOTE

This Policy applies equally to employees in India and the United States. Where different entitlements apply based on geography, these are explicitly called out in each section. When in doubt about which rule applies, employees must consult HR in writing before incurring the expense — not after.

03

DEFINITIONS

Key terms used throughout this Policy

Term	Meaning
Business Travel	Any travel undertaken at the direction of Spyne for an official business purpose, with prior written approval.
Base City / Location	The city in which the employee's primary office or remote work location is registered.
HOD	Head of Department — the senior-most functional leader of the employee's team.
RM / Reporting Manager	The employee's direct line manager.
Per Diem	A fixed daily allowance covering meals, incidentals, and minor out-of-pocket costs. No receipts required.
Tour Advance	A cash or forex-card advance provided before overseas travel to cover anticipated expenses.
Economy Class	The economy cabin class on commercial airlines; includes standard seats on trains/buses
Category A / B / C	Country classification tiers used to determine overseas expense limits. See Section 6.1.
Tier A / B	City classification used for India & US travel expense limits. See Section 6.1
Keka	Spyne's HR and expense management platform used by India employees.
GST Invoice	Tax-compliant invoice required for India reimbursement claims.

04

APPROVAL AUTHORITY & PROCESS

Required approvals before any travel can be initiated

No business travel may be undertaken without prior written (email) approval. Verbal approvals are not valid under this Policy.

4.1 Approval Chain

Travel Type	Required Approvers	Advance Notice Required
Local / within-city (India)	Head of Department (HOD)	Before travel commences
Domestic Outstation (India & US)	HOD	15 business days
International / Overseas (all employees)	HOD + CEO	30 business days
Any deviation from the given “Advance Notice” required for Travel Commencement will need approval from Finance Head as well		

 IMPORTANT NOTICE

Any travel undertaken without documented email approval is considered unauthorised. Expenses from unauthorised travel will NOT be reimbursed. The company accepts no liability whatsoever for the safety, health, or financial losses of employees who travel without proper approval.

4.2 Step-by-Step Approval Process

1. Employee emails HOD cc to Reporting Manager with travel purpose, dates, destination.
2. HOD approves and forwards to HR/ Admin. For overseas travel, HOD forwards to the CEO for final sign-off.
3. HOD / CEO approval is forwarded to the HR/ Admin team to initiate bookings.
4. Admin confirms tickets, hotel, insurance, and forex at least 48 hours before departure.
5. For India outstation: HOD provides final approval before Admin proceeds.

05

TRAVEL DOCUMENTS & COMPLIANCE

Mandatory documentation every international traveller must carry

Employees travelling internationally are solely responsible for ensuring their travel documents are valid, current, and complete before and during the trip.

Document	Requirement
Valid Passport	Minimum 6 months validity beyond the return date.
Visa	Valid visa for destination country. Initiate application at least 30 working days in advance.
Travel Insurance	Company-arranged policy (mandatory). Carry the certificate during the trip.
Government-issued Photo ID	Must be carried at all times.
Digital Backups	Store copies of all documents in personal email or secure cloud storage.

 LEGAL NOTICE

DISCLAIMER: The company will not be responsible for missed flights, denied boarding, visa rejections, entry refusals, or any financial loss arising from the employee's failure to maintain valid or accurate travel documents. Costs resulting from document-related issues are entirely the employee's personal liability. The company will not initiate any legal, financial, or insurance claim on behalf of an employee whose loss is attributable to their own negligence.

06

OVERSEAS & INTERNATIONAL TRAVEL

Applies to all employees — India and US — travelling internationally

6.1 Country and Cities Classification

All overseas destinations are classified into three categories which determine expense limits:

Cat.	Label	India	US
A	Tier A	Delhi, Gurugram, Mumbai, Bengaluru, Chennai, Kolkata, Hyderabad, Ahmedabad, Pune	US: New York, Los Angeles, San Francisco, Las Vegas, Boston, Washington, Houston, Dallas, Miami, Seattle, Atlanta
B	Tier B	All State Capitals and Union Territories not listed in Tier A	US: All other cities except Category A

6.2 Flights & Boarding

- All international flights must be booked in Economy class.
- Business or Premium Economy is not permitted unless any upgrade chosen by the employee beyond standard economy is a personal expense and will not be reimbursed.
- Flights are booked by the Admin team.
- Airport taxes and standard baggage fees are reimbursable. Excess baggage is the employee's responsibility unless business-critical and pre-approved.

6.3 Accommodation (Lodging) — Overseas

Cat.	Max / Night (USD)	Applies To	Notes
A	Up to USD 130	US -Tier A cities (US: New York, Los Angeles, San Francisco, Las Vegas, Boston, Washington, Houston, Dallas, Miami, Seattle, Atlanta)	Includes room + taxes + service charge
B	Up to USD 120	US standard cities (all except Cat. A)	Includes room + taxes + service charge

- For stays exceeding 7 consecutive nights, employees are expected to book service apartments or extended-stay options.
- Employees sharing accommodation must declare this; only one lodging claim will be processed.
- Employees staying with family/friends receive a flat per diem of USD 100/day covering stay and meals combined.
- Mini-bar, personal spa, in-room dining above meal limits, laundry, and paid entertainment are NOT reimbursable.

6.4 Per Diem (Daily Allowance) — Overseas

Per diem is a fixed daily allowance. No receipts are required. Amounts cannot be carried forward to the next day.

Cat.	Per Diem / Day (USD)	What It Covers	Applies To
A	USD 70	Meals, incidentals, gratuities, minor transit	US Tier A cities
B	USD 60	Meals, incidentals, gratuities, minor transit	US standard cities

NOTE

Per diem rates are benchmarked against GSA-influenced standards applicable to early-to-growth-stage US technology companies. Rates are reviewed annually and may be revised with 30 days' notice.

6.5 Local Transport at Destination — Overseas

- Economy transport only — Uber X / Go, standard taxi, metro, shuttle. Premium or luxury options are not reimbursable.
- Actual bills must be submitted; claims without receipts will not be processed.
- Home-to-airport and airport-to-home travel at the employee's base location is reimbursed on actuals.

6.6 Additional Allowances — Overseas

Allowance	Amount	Conditions
Phone / Communication	Up to USD 4 / day	Actual bills required against mobile/data usage
Laundry	USD 10 flat per 10-day block	Applicable for trips exceeding 10 days; additional USD 10 per subsequent 10-day period
Tour Advance	Up to USD 125/day as per category	Disbursed via company-provided forex card; settlement required within 30 days of return

07

INDIA DOMESTIC TRAVEL

Applies to all India-based employees travelling within India

7.1 Within-City Travel (India)

Reimbursement for work-related travel within the employee's base city (client meetings, vendor visits, field activities, on-ground tasks):

Mode	Rate	Daily Cap	Documentation Required
2-Wheeler (Personal vehicle)	INR 4.5 / km	INR 500 / day	Odometer reading
4-Wheeler (Personal vehicle)	INR 10 / km	INR 800 / day	Odometer reading

Cab / Auto / Metro / Rapido	Actuals	No fixed cap	Digital GST invoice
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- Only Ola Go, Uber Mini, Rapido, or equivalent economy modes are reimbursable. Premium tiers (Uber Black, Ola Prime XL) are not covered.
- Metro and public transport are fully reimbursed with valid ticket slips.
- Daily home-to-office and return commutes are NOT reimbursable under any circumstance.
- Field day meals (full day external or declared holiday): up to INR 500/day with bill submission. Excess requires skip-level approval.

7.2 Mode of Travel — India Outstation

Travel Mode	Permitted Class / Standard
Air Travel	Economy class only. Pre-approval from HOD is required. Business/First class is not permitted.
Train	2nd AC (2AC) or 1st AC (1AC) with pre-approval. Rajdhani / Shatabdi
AC Bus/ Cab	Any standard AC bus/ Cab service where air/train is not practical.

- Tickets are booked by the Admin team.
- Business or First-class air/train tickets will not be reimbursed under any band or grade.

7.3 Hotel Stay Limits — India Outstation

City Tier	Hotel Cap per Night (INR + taxes)	Notes
Tier A	Up to INR 6,000 + applicable taxes	Delhi, Mumbai, Bengaluru, Chennai, Kolkata, Hyderabad, Pune, Gurugram
Tier B	Up to INR 3,000 + applicable taxes	State capitals and Union Territories

7.4 Meal Reimbursement — India Outstation

Applies To	Daily Meal Limit
All employees (India outstation)	Up to INR 800 / day — bills required

- All meal claims must be supported by valid GST invoices.
- Bills for alcohol and tobacco will NOT be reimbursed under any category or band.
- Room service costs are not reimbursable unless within meal limits and supported by itemised bills.

7.5 Local Conveyance — India Outstation

- Local transport at the outstation destination is reimbursed on actuals via Ola Mini, Uber Go, Rapido, metro, or public transport — with valid receipts.
- Rental cars without a driver are permitted only in exceptional cases with pre-approval from HOD.
- Fuel reimbursement is applicable only when the employee is self-driving with a sanctioned rental vehicle.

08

TRAVEL INSURANCE

Mandatory coverage for all international travel

- All employees travelling internationally must be covered under an overseas medical insurance policy. The company arranges this through the Admin team.
- Employees must carry a valid insurance certificate during the trip at all times.
- Insurance covers hospitalisation and consultation costs incurred due to illness or injury during the official trip.
- In emergencies where the insurer is not accepted, the company will review and may reimburse treatment costs on a case-by-case basis, subject to full documentation.
- Insurance does NOT cover: pre-existing conditions, elective procedures, cosmetic treatments, or illnesses resulting from alcohol or substance use.

⚠ IMPORTANT NOTICE

IMPORTANT: The company's liability is strictly limited to reimbursement of treatment costs that fall within the insurance policy's scope.

The company is not liable for medical decisions, outcomes, or treatment costs that exceed policy coverage, are excluded by the policy, or arise from the employee's personal conduct. Employees are strongly advised to review the insurance policy document before travel.

09

CLAIMS & REIMBURSEMENT PROCESS

How to submit claims, timelines, and advance settlement

9.1 Submission Timelines

Travel Type	 India Employees	 US Employees
Within city / local	7 business days from expense date	7 business days from expense date
Domestic outstation	10 business days from return date	10 business days from return date
International / Overseas	15 business days from return date	15 business days from return date
Tour advance settlement	30 calendar days from return date	30 calendar days from return date

⚠ IMPORTANT NOTICE

STRICT ENFORCEMENT: Claims submitted after the above timelines may be declined at the Company's discretion, subject to reasonable justification and HOD approval.

The company will not entertain retrospective exceptions. Failure to return unused tour advances within 30 days of returning may result in forfeiture and/or recovery from salary.

9.2 How to Submit Claims

India Employees

- Submit all expense claims on Keka within the specified timeline.
- Attach all original digital or physical bills/receipts for every item claimed.
- Include GST-compliant invoices for hotel and service bills.
- Include the travel approval email thread.
- For outstation claims: consolidate bills in a zip file supported by an itemised Excel sheet.
- Reimbursements are processed within 10 working days, provided bills are approved before the 20th of each month.

United States Employees

- Submit all expense claims on Keka within the specified timeline.
- Attach all relevant receipts, travel tickets, and the approval email thread and get it approved by your HOD
- Reimbursements are processed in the next payroll cycle following approval.

9.3 Tour Advance Settlement — Overseas

- All tour advances must be fully accounted for within 30 calendar days of returning from the overseas trip.
- Advances are reviewed and approved by the Reporting Manager and HR.
- Unutilised advance amounts must be returned to Finance within the same 30-day window. Finance will issue a written acknowledgment.
- The Company may recover unreturned advances in accordance with applicable law, from the employee's salary, with written notice issued at least 5 days prior to any deduction.

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NON-REIMBURSABLE EXPENSES

Expenses that will not be reimbursed under any circumstance

The following expenses will NOT be reimbursed regardless of who incurred them or what justification is provided:

	Expense — Not Reimbursable
✗	Daily home-to-office and office-to-home commutes
✗	Personal detours, leisure activities, tourism, sightseeing, or entertainment (movies, shows, theme parks, etc.)
✗	Alcohol, tobacco products, or controlled substances
✗	Personal shopping, gifts, or lifestyle purchases
✗	Travel class or accommodation upgrades not pre-approved in writing by the CEO
✗	Mini-bar, in-room dining billed above meal limits, personal spa, gym, or paid TV / streaming services
✗	Fines, penalties, traffic violations, or legal fees arising during travel
✗	Damage to rental vehicles or hotel property caused by the employee
✗	Travel not directly related to the stated and approved business purpose
✗	Travel undertaken without prior written approval
✗	Claims submitted after the stipulated deadline (unless a prior written extension was granted)

✗	Costs arising from missed flights, expired documents, or visa issues due to employee negligence
✗	Loss of personal cash, cards, electronics, or other property
✗	Expenses incurred for personal guests, family members, or companions

LEGAL NOTICE

ANTI-ABUSE NOTICE: Any attempt to claim personal expenses as business expenses, inflate mileage or distance, submit fabricated receipts, claim for travel not undertaken, or exploit ambiguity in this Policy to receive reimbursements beyond its intent will be treated as a serious disciplinary offence.

This includes termination of employment and, where applicable, civil and/or criminal legal action for financial misconduct. Managers who knowingly approve fraudulent claims will also be held accountable.

11

CLIENT ENTERTAINMENT & BUSINESS MEALS

Rules for entertaining clients, investors, and partners

- Business meals with external clients, investors, or partners are reimbursable on actuals with itemised receipts, subject to prior approval.
- Alcohol at business meals is NOT reimbursable by Spyne under any circumstance, regardless of who requested it or local cultural norms.
- Entertainment expenses (tickets, events, activities) require written pre-approval from the HOD and a clear documented business justification.
- The employee hosting the meal must record the names and organisations of all attendees on the expense report.
- Per-person meal cost at client dinners should be reasonable and proportionate. Lavish expenditure without documented business justification may be partially or fully declined by Finance.

12

TRAVEL SAFETY GUIDELINES

Expected conduct and safety standards during all business travel

12.1 At the Airport

- Arrive at least 2–3 hours before departure for international flights; 90 minutes for domestic flights.
- Always carry a government-issued photo ID and valid passport. Maintain digital backups in email or cloud storage.
- Double-check terminal, gate, and boarding times. Changes are the employee's personal responsibility to monitor.
- Do not leave baggage unattended. Report suspicious items to airport authorities immediately.
- Remain reachable by phone or email during travel for HR/Admin coordination.

12.2 At Accommodation

- Check in with valid ID. Verify booking details on arrival and report any discrepancies to Admin immediately.
- Lock valuables in the in-room safe. Do not share room access with outsiders.
- Do not invite non-Spyne individuals into company-booked accommodation.
- For trips involving employees of multiple genders, separate rooms must be arranged by Admin. No exceptions.
- Any damage caused to hotel property by the employee is the employee's personal financial responsibility.

12.3 During Transit

- Use only approved, economy transport modes as outlined in this Policy.
- Avoid carrying excessive cash. Use travel cards or corporate credit cards where available.
- Avoid personal detours, unauthorised stops, or activities that could endanger yourself or others.
- The company is not responsible for lost personal items, cash, or electronics during transit.

12.4 Emergencies

- In any emergency — medical, legal, safety, or travel disruption — immediately notify your Reporting Manager AND the HR/Admin SPOC.
- In life-threatening situations: call local emergency services first (911 in the US; 112 in India/Europe), then notify HR.
- Comply fully with local laws, regulations, and hotel policies in the country of travel.
- Employees must not engage in illegal activity, substance abuse, or any conduct that could expose themselves, colleagues, or the company to legal risk during business travel.

LEGAL NOTICE

SAFETY DISCLAIMER: Spyne exercises reasonable duty of care by providing travel guidance, insurance, and administrative support. However, the company is NOT liable for personal injuries, accidents, illness, death, legal complications, or property loss during business travel that arise from: the employee's personal negligence; failure to follow this Policy or safety guidelines; acts of God or force majeure; local political, civil, or security conditions; or activities outside the sanctioned business purpose of the trip.

Employees acknowledge that certain risks may arise during travel beyond the Company's control. The Company will provide reasonable assistance and insurance coverage as outlined in this Policy.

13

EXCEPTIONS & ESCALATIONS

How to request deviations from this Policy

- Exceptions to any provision of this Policy require pre-approval — not post-facto ratification. Retroactive exceptions are discouraged and will be considered only in exceptional circumstances with appropriate justification and approval.
- Exception requests must be submitted in writing to the HOD and HR Head, clearly stating the business justification and estimated additional cost.
- Expenses exceeding standard limits due to special business needs or leadership requirements require written approval from the COO or CEO.
- The company reserves the right to decline any exception request, even with prior intermediate approval, if it does not meet cost-efficiency or governance standards.

GOOD PRACTICE

Good Judgement Test: Before incurring any expense, ask — would a senior leader at Spyne view this as a reasonable and necessary business expense? If the answer is uncertain, seek written approval before spending. The company will not reimburse expenses that fail this test, even if technically within stated limits.

14

LEGAL PROTECTIONS & EMPLOYEE OBLIGATIONS

Rights, obligations, and liability boundaries

14.1 Policy Gaps & Ambiguity

This Policy is designed to be comprehensive. However, no policy can anticipate every possible situation. Where this Policy is silent on a specific matter:

- Employees must NOT use the absence of an explicit provision as a basis to claim entitlement or to take any action.
- Employees must seek clarification from HR in writing before incurring the expense or taking the action.
- HR's written interpretation of any gap shall constitute the authoritative guidance for that situation.
- Any attempt to exploit a policy gap for personal financial gain or to circumvent the intent of this Policy will be treated as a breach of the employee's duty of good faith and may result in disciplinary action.

14.2 No Legal Claims Against the Company for Travel Events

By undertaking business travel on behalf of Spyne, employees acknowledge and agree that:

- Spyne does not guarantee employee safety during business travel. While the company makes reasonable efforts, it cannot control external environments, third-party service providers, or unforeseen events.
- Employees acknowledge that business travel involves inherent risks. The Company's responsibility shall be limited to providing reasonable support, including insurance coverage, in accordance with this Policy and applicable law.
- The company's liability is limited to the coverage provided under the company-arranged travel insurance policy and this reimbursement Policy. No additional financial obligation arises beyond this scope.
- Employees who misrepresent expenses, falsify receipts, or manipulate claims will be required to refund all amounts paid and may be subject to civil and/or criminal action.

⚠ IMPORTANT NOTICE

This Policy does not create an employment contract, guarantee of continued employment, or any right to travel. The company reserves the right to cancel, modify, or restrict business travel at any time for any business reason without creating any liability to the employee. Travel plans may be revoked or changed without compensation for non-reimbursable personal expenses already incurred by the employee.

14.3 Employee Acknowledgment Obligation

- All employees must read this Policy in full before undertaking any business travel.
- Employees are required to sign and return the Acknowledgment Form at the end of this document to HR. This will be retained in the employee's HR file.
- Managers and HODs who approve travel requests are deemed to have confirmed the travel is aligned with business objectives, this Policy, and Spyne's financial standards.

15

POLICY GOVERNANCE & REVIEW

How this Policy is maintained, updated, and communicated

- This Policy is owned by the Human Resources team and is subject to annual review.
- Ad hoc revisions may be made at any time in response to business needs, legal changes, or operational requirements.
- Employees will be notified of material changes via email with at least 30 days' notice before the effective date. Changes to legal compliance clauses may take immediate effect.
- The most current version will always be accessible on the company's internal HR portal or SharePoint.
- All prior versions of any Spyne travel policy are superseded by this document as of the effective date above.
- Questions regarding this Policy should be directed to HR before travel. HR's written response constitutes the binding interpretation.

16

POINTS OF CONTACT (SPOC)

Who to contact for travel-related queries

Function	Contact Person(s)	Scope of Queries
HR — Policy, Approvals & Documentation	Sangeetha Swamy, Shankul Rastogi	Travel policy queries, approval chain, documentation, acknowledgment forms
Finance — Advances & Reimbursements	Rahul Beruwar, Ved Prakash Gupta	Tour advances, expense claims, reimbursements, advance returns, salary recovery
Admin — Bookings & Logistics	Admin Team	Flight/hotel bookings, forex, insurance, airport transfers, documentation handover